



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING

Monday, June 3, 2024, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting on Monday, June 3, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM by Mr. Scott Johndrow.

Present: Scott Johndrow, Susan Bronstein, Jennifer Milikowsky

Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.

Department Reports

Highway – Bill Jablonski

Mr. Jablonski noted recent work that had been completed by the department:

- Paving of a portion of Southampton Road
- Replacement of a fire vehicle battery
- Placed flags up along roadways
- Began summer mowing
- Repaired some rainstorm washouts on dirt roads

Mr. Johndrow noted that a well backup generator that has been in the planning process may need to be delayed to a personal injury on the part of the electrician who was slated to do the work.

Mr. Jablonski will look into potential alternative electricians who may be able to perform the work. Mr. Johndrow will see if the general designs and specs can be obtained.

Special Town Meeting - Review / Approve Warrant

The board took up a conversation relative to a budget shortfall for the FY2025 fiscal year. Mr. Finn explained that a special town meeting before the end of the year will be necessary to make some adjustments to the final budget for FY25, due to an error in the revenue calculations.

Mr. Finn noted the following options:

- Eliminate Highway Clerk position, which would save \$10,032
- Reduce Highway Materials Budget, which would save \$10,000
- Reduce Transfer Station Expense, which would save \$10,000
- Rescind use of Free Cash for Computers, which would save \$15,000

After some discussion, the board agreed as follows:

The board declined to eliminate the highway clerk position, noting that it would serve an essential purpose and that it would increase the capacity of the department.

The board declined to reduce the highway materials budget, noting that price increases in

materials means that the proposed increase in the line will simply keep up with inflation. The board declined to adjust the Transfer Station budget.

The board agreed to request that Town Meeting rescind the \$15,000 appropriation from free cash to purchase new computers, noting that the purchase could be made using ARPA funding, and would relieve the town of the expense.

Without objection, Mr. Johndrow opened the warrant for a Special Town Meeting, to be held on June 24, 2024, 7 PM, at the Town Hall, 1 South Road, Westhampton.

Without objection, two warrant articles were included:

ARTICLE 1: To see if the town will vote to rescind its action relative to Article 34 of the Annual Town Meeting, held on June 11, 2024, which transferred the sum of \$15,000 from free cash for purchase of replacement computer workstations, laptops, monitors, printers and accessories for use by municipal employees at the Town Hall, Town Annex, Westhampton Public Library, and Public Safety Complex, or take any other action relative thereto.

ARTICLE 2: To see if the Town will vote to transfer from Free Cash, or other available funds, a sum of money to Balance the Budget and to Reduce the Tax Rate for the Fiscal Year 2025, or take any other action relative thereto.

After discussion and review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To close warrant for Special Town Meeting, and forward the completed warrant to the Town Clerk for posting.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:27 PM)

ARPA Appropriation

Mr. Finn noted that, while the board had discussed the matter, an appropriation from ARPA had not yet been formally approved by the board for the purchase of the proposed Solar PV Array for Town Hall. Mr. Finn noted that the preliminary estimate (after the federal direct pay incentive) was \$53,760.00.

After discussion, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appropriate \$53,760.00 from the CLFRF / ARPA for the purpose of the purchase and installation of a solar PV array to be constructed on Town Hall, 1 South Road, Westhampton.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (7:31 PM)

ADA Grievance Procedure

Ms. Milikowsky noted that she had not yet had time to review the proposed ADA grievance procedure. The matter was tabled to the next regular agenda.

Department Reports

See highway report, above.

No other departments offered a report.

Administrative Business

Review Correspondence

General correspondence was reviewed. No action taken on any specific item.

Review and Sign: Payroll and A/P Warrants: W24-25, WP24-25

The Payroll and A/P warrants were reviewed.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the warrants as presented, and to sign.

There was a question in regard to a \$1,911 expense under 015232.700 (Mickelson Medical Services), which was largely resolved after review of the warrant supporting information. Mr. Johndrow later noted that the purchase was for EMS supplies, and that the purchase was confirmed by Fire Chief David Antosz.

VOTE: 3, 0, 0. (7:40 PM)

Review and Sign: Minutes from Previous Meetings

The minutes from May 20, 2024 were distributed for review. After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the minutes as presented.

VOTED: 2, 0, 1 (MILIKOWSKY) (7:42 PM)

Upcoming Events:

Upcoming meetings were tentatively scheduled: June 17, 7 PM, July 1, 7 PM

The date for the Special Town Meeting: June 24, 2024, 7 PM

Executive Session – if needed or requested

Mr. Finn requested an executive session to discuss the potential departure of a staff member, noting that the reasons for the potential departure would likely qualify as an allowable reason for discussion under executive session, as it dealt with “the reputation, character, physical condition or mental health, rather than professional competence, of an individual, or to discuss the discipline or dismissal of, or complaints or charges brought against, a public officer, employee, staff member or individual.”

It was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To enter into executive session for the reasons as requested.

VOTED: Bronstein: Yes; Milikowsky: Yes; Johndrow: Yes (7:44)

The board entered into executive session at about 7:45 PM.

Executive Session

It was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky,

To exit executive session.

VOTED: BRONSTEIN: YES; MILIKOWSKY: YES; JOHNDROW: YES. (8:14 PM)

Business not reasonably anticipated 48 hours in advance of Meeting

Election Followup:

Mr. Johndrow noted reports relative to certain details about the Town Election on June 1 were concerning to him, not because they impacted the impartiality of the election in any significant way, but that the problems should be addressed prior to the State Primary elections in September, and the national election in November.

Contract for Services – Hazard Mitigation Plan Update

Mr. Finn noted that the board received a draft contract for services provided by the Pioneer Valley Planning Commission for update to the Town's Hazardous Mitigation Plan. The services as provided by the PVPC would be paid for by a state grant.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the contract and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (8:15 PM)

Adjournment

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To adjourn.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (8:16 PM)

Respectfully submitted,
Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on June 17, 2024.

Maureen Dempsey

Scott Johndrow

